How to run the AI Supplier Document Reader

You can run the workflow on the fictional test set in about 15 minutes. You need n8n and an OpenAI API key; a full run costs a few cents.

≈ 15 min | ≈ $0.04 per run | n8n 2.x

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01 — WHAT YOU NEED

ITEM	NOTES
n8n	Version 2.x. Self-hosted (`npx n8n` , Docker) or n8n Cloud. Built and tested on 2.43.
OpenAI API key	From platform.openai.com, with a few dollars of credit. A full test run costs about $0.04.
`Supplier_document_reader_EN.json`	The workflow file.
`VELOX_test_documents.zip`	12 fictional supplier documents, the 2 ERP templates, `Expected_result.xlsx` and a README.

To run n8n locally with Node.js installed, open a terminal and run:

```
$ npx n8n
```

then open `http://localhost:5678` in your browser.

02 — STEPS

Seven steps to a result

1 **Unzip the test documents**

Unzip into a folder, for example `test_documents` . Leave `Expected_result.xlsx` and `README.md` aside: they are for checking, not for uploading.

2 **Import the workflow**

In n8n, create a new workflow, open the ... menu at the top right, choose **Import from File** and pick `Supplier_document_reader_EN.json` . Save it.

3 **Add your OpenAI key**

Open the node **Ask OpenAI**. Under Credential, choose **Create new credential**, paste your API key and save. The credential stored in the file belongs to my account and won't work for you.

4 **Check the model**

Open the node **RULEBOOK** and find the `ai` section near the top. `model` and `modelScan` name the OpenAI models used. If your account doesn't offer that model, replace both with a current low-cost model from your OpenAI account's model list.

5 **Run it**

Click **Execute workflow**. A form opens in a new tab titled "Upload order confirmations and delivery notes".

6 **Upload the documents**

Drag all files from `test_documents` onto the form and click **Submit**. The run takes a minute or two; the long delivery note is read page by page.

7 **Download the result**

When the form says "Your result is ready", `Result.zip` downloads. It holds `OC.xlsx`, `DN.xlsx` and `Review.xlsx`. Open `Review.xlsx` first.

03 — CHECKING THE RESULT

Compare against the expected answer

`Expected_result.xlsx` holds the correct answer for every document: 73 order confirmation rows and 425 delivery note rows, each with a *Source file* column. Compare it with `OC.xlsx` and `DN.xlsx` from your run.

The two ERP templates are in the upload on purpose. They are not supplier documents, so the workflow must report them instead of reading them.

WHAT YOU UPLOAD	OC ROWS	DN ROWS	EXPECTED IN REVIEW.XLSX
Everything	73	425	2 templates (unknown supplier), 2 PDF duplicates skipped, 4 scan lines
Only the Excel files	46	395	The 2 templates
Only the 8 PDFs	73	425	4 scan lines

TRY IT · SEE THE SELF-CHECK WORK

In **RULEBOOK**, change `splitAbovePages: 4` to `99` and run only the PDFs. The 14-page delivery note is then sent as one request. If the AI skips lines, `Review.xlsx` lists the missing product codes. AI behaviour varies, so it may take a few runs to see it. Set the value back to 4 afterwards.

04 — COMMON PROBLEMS

If something goes wrong

PROBLEM	FIX
Ask OpenAI shows a credential error	The imported credential is mine. Select or create your own in Ask OpenAI (step 3).
`OpenAI error: … model … does not exist` in Review.xlsx	Your account lacks that model. Change `model` and `modelScan` in RULEBOOK (step 4).
`OpenAI error: … quota` or `insufficient`	Add credit to your OpenAI account.
A file shows "Unknown supplier"	Expected for the 2 templates. For any other file, its supplier has no entry in RULEBOOK yet.
Scans misread	Set `modelScan` in RULEBOOK to a stronger model; scan lines are always listed in Review.xlsx for a visual check.
The form doesn't open	Click Execute workflow again; the test form only works while the workflow is waiting for it.

Adding your own supplier

Copy an existing entry in RULEBOOK and change its identifying words, document-type keywords, rules and product-code pattern. Test it on 2–3 of that supplier's documents before trusting it.